HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Other people are the reason I use. If they treated me better, I wouldn't need it."

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Other people are the reason I use. If they treated me better, I wouldn't need it." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did they actually do, and what have I added by saying I have no choice?
- ☐ Can their wrong be real and my next step still be mine?
- ☐ What help is available even if they never apologize?
- ☐ Who is a safe person who is not the person I am blaming?
- ☐ What would I want for a friend in this exact spot?
- ☐ Where does my help come from if it does not come from their reform?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ People have hurt me, and that is real. Their treatment does not remove my next step. I can get help even if they do not change.
- ☐ What other people did can be truly wrong.
- ☐ I do not have to excuse them in order to get help.
- ☐ I also do not have to wait for them before I ask for help.
- ☐ God's help is not on their timetable.
- ☐ A counselor can help me hold both truths.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 121:1–2
  "I lift up my eyes to the hills. From where does my help come? My help comes from the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth."
- ☐ Psalm 34:18
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."
- ☐ Matthew 11:28
  "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When you gave them the whole reason: Each day, write down one moment when someone else's treatment felt like the reason you had to use. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 121:2 becomes: "James can write: "My help comes from the Lord. I do not have to wait for them to change.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Suffering" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. For help with substance use, call 1-800-662-4357, and talk with a doctor before you stop if withdrawal could make you sick.

- [ ] Write two lines. "What they did" and "the step I can take anyway." Do not use the second line to excuse the first.
- [ ] Tell a helper who is not the person you blame. A counselor, a doctor, or 1-800-662-4357.
- [ ] Ask a doctor before you change how you stop. Do not make a sudden stop your way of proving them wrong.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 121:1–2 when you want to wait for them to become kinder.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Other people are the reason I use. If they treated me better, I wouldn't need it.": _____ %

My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A step I took without waiting for them
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Other people are the reason I use. If they treated me better, I wouldn't need it~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, people have hurt me, and I have used that as the whole reason. Be near the brokenhearted. Give me help that does not wait on their change. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.